(v) An ***autonomous body*** entitled to form its own views on important issues and place them before the governments. It works closely with the Union and State cabinets and has full knowledge of their policies.[48]

(vi) Is invariably ***consulted*** on changes proposed in social and economic policies. To ensure free and full exchange of ideas, the P.C has established a ***convention*** that it will not give publicity to differences of views between the Commission and the Union and State Governments.[48]

(vii) ***Linked*** with the Union Cabinet at the secretariat level. The PC is part of the Cabinet organisation and the 'demand for grants' for it is included in the budget demand for the Cabinet Secretariat.[48]

(viii) Seated at the 'Yojana Bhavan', the Commission has a staff of Secretaries and Advisers and also a research organisation.[48]

(ix) The PC is a ***technical body*** with experts and professionals coming from an array of specific areas as per the need of planning of the concerned period.(see Reference 42).

(x) The Commission has ***executive powers.***[49]

## Functions of the PC

Though the PC was set up with a definite purpose of planning, nobody knew that it would extend its functions over the entire spectrum of administration in the country. It was described as the 'economic Cabinet of the country as a whole' even encroaching upon the constitutional body like the finance commission[50] and not being accountable to the parliament.[51] Through time it built up a heavy bureaucratic organisation[52] which led even Nehru himself to observe— "The Commission which was a small body of serious thinkers has turned into a government department complete with a crowd of secretaries, directors and of course a big building."[53]

Though the functions of the PC were extended to include timely changes in the planning needs (in the reforms era), its functions were announced by the same government order which did set up the Planning Commission, itself. The order[54] says: